General rules for dimensioning

1. Dimension should be placed outside the view as far as possible.
2. Dimension lines should not intersect each other.
3. Dimension lines should not be placed cutting an extension line.
4. Dimension lines should be given on the view which shows the relevant feature most clearly.
5. Dimension should never be crowded. If the spaces is not sufficient , arrow heads may be replaced by dots or inclined lines.
6. The distance between the outline of the object and first dimension line should be at least 10mm.
7. A distance of atleast 8mm should be kept between two adjacent dimension lines.
8. The extension line should not project beyond 2mm from the dimension line.
9. Leader lines should be constructed at an angle to the horizontal(30°, 45° and 60°)
10. Center lines should not be used as dimension line.
11. Dimensions with smaller sizes should be placed near the drawing than those with bigger sizes.
12. Dimensions marked in one view need not be repeated in other views.
13. While dimensioning angles, their values are placed outside the view.
14. Remarks , instructions and foot notes should be written horizontally.
15. Dimensions of part which are not drawn to scale should be underlined. If the whole drawing is not drawn to scale , a note should be made in the drawings as 'NOT TO SCALE'.
16. When all the dimensions are in same unit, there is no need to mention the unit. Instead a foot note should be written as 'ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN mm'.
17. The size of the datum plane should be written within brackets.
18. While dimensioning external threads , the type , size and length should be marked.
19. The size of the arcs should be indicated by its radius.
20. The diameter of the circle is always specified as follows